

PLAYIQ ACADEMY

COURSE CURRICULUM

Foundations of Human-AI Collaboration: Modules 1-3

SECTOR: PARENT GATEWAY

DATE: June 2026

VERSION: 1.0.0

MODULE 1: AI LEARNING CODE

Node 1: What AI Is Good At vs Bad At

THE BIG IDEA

- AI is powerful, but it is not magic.
- It can help you learn faster. It can also confuse you if you use it badly.

AI is good at:

- explaining ideas in different ways
- giving examples
- helping break down a hard topic
- quizzing you
- helping you organize your thoughts

AI is bad at:

- always being correct
- fully understanding your teacher's exact expectations
- knowing when something is missing
- replacing your judgment

Read this carefully

- AI often sounds confident. That is important. Something can sound polished, clear, and smart... and still be wrong.
- So one of the most important rules in this program is: Confident is not the same as correct.

Why this matters for you

- If you use AI well, it can help you: understand faster, get unstuck faster, learn in a way that fits your brain.
- If you use AI badly, it can: do the thinking for you, make you trust weak answers, make you feel smart without actually learning.
- The goal in PlayIQ is not to look smart. The goal is to become smarter.

ACTIVITY: GOOD USE, RISKY USE, OR BAD USE?

Instructions:

- Read each example and decide whether it is: Good Use, Risky Use, or Bad Use.
- Then answer the 2 reflection questions in full sentences.

Scenarios:

- "Explain photosynthesis like I'm 12."
- "Write my entire essay for me."
- "Give me 5 practice questions about fractions."

- "Tell me the exact answer to my worksheet."
- "Help me understand what I got wrong."
- "Summarize this paragraph, then quiz me on it."
- "Solve all my homework and I'll copy it."
- "Give me a simpler example of this equation."

Reflection Prompts:

- One way AI can help me learn better is...
- One way AI could make me weaker if I used it badly is...

MINI CHECK

- Why can AI be useful for learning?
- Why is AI sometimes risky to trust?
- What is one sign that an AI answer should be checked?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain to a younger student why AI can be useful but still needs to be checked."

Node 2: Choosing the Right AI Mode

THE BIG IDEA

- Different problems need different kinds of help.
- If you use the wrong mode, learning gets slower, messier, and more frustrating. If you use the right mode, learning gets faster and clearer.
- In PlayIQ, your AI is not just answering you. It is also learning how to teach you better.
- That means the way you respond, the kinds of prompts you use, and the modes you choose all help shape your AI into a better coach for your brain.

The 6 Modes

- 1. Explain Mode: Use this when learning something new, wanting a simpler explanation, or wanting something taught in your specific style.
- 2. Hint Mode: Use this when you already started a problem, want a clue (not the answer), and want to keep your brain doing the work.
- 3. Quiz Mode: Use this when testing memory or checking if you really understand before a test.
- 4. Coach Mode: Use this when you need a plan, feel overwhelmed, or want structure to your studying time.
- 5. Learn Your Way Mode: Use this when explanations are not clicking and you want the AI to learn how your brain works.
- 6. Lesson Rescue Mode: Use this when a whole paragraph/note is confusing and you need help finding exactly where you got lost.

ACTIVITY: PICK THE BEST MODE

Instructions:

- Now that you know the six modes, you're going to practice using them.
- Choose the best mode for each situation below. Make sure to specify the exact mode.

Scenarios:

- You want to understand a confusing paragraph from biology.
- You already tried a math problem and want a clue.
- You want to test whether you remember yesterday's lesson.
- You need a study plan for an exam next week.
- You pasted your notes and want help finding the confusing part.
- You want the explanation changed to fit how you learn best.

MINI CHECK

- When should you use Hint Mode instead of Explain Mode?

- When is Lesson Rescue Mode better than Coach Mode?
- Why does choosing the right mode matter?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Teach someone when they should use Hint Mode instead of Explain Mode."

Node 3: Ask Better Questions

THE BIG IDEA

- The quality of your learning depends on the quality of your questions.
- Weak questions lead to weak learning. Better questions lead to better learning.
- When you ask better questions, your AI gets better at helping you. It learns your gaps, your thinking, and how to teach you faster.

Weak question vs strong question

- Weak question: "What's the answer?" (That pushes AI to think for you)
- Better questions: "Can you explain this simply?" "Give me a hint instead of the answer." "What do students usually misunderstand here?"

The Question Ladder

- Step 1: What is this?
- Step 2: Why does it work this way?
- Step 3: Can you explain it more simply?
- Step 4: Can you show me an example?
- Step 5: Can you test me on it?
- Step 6: Can you ask me questions that will help me learn this faster?

ACTIVITY: UPGRADE THESE WEAK PROMPTS

Instructions:

- Rewrite each weak prompt underneath it so it helps you learn instead of shortcutting.
- After that, write 3 strong prompts for something you're currently learning in school.

Scenarios:

- "What's the answer?"
- "Do this for me."
- "Write my paragraph."
- "Solve this worksheet."
- "Tell me what to put."

MINI CHECK

- Why are better questions important?
- What is the difference between a shortcut prompt and a coaching prompt?

- What kind of prompt would you use if you wanted a simpler explanation and then a test?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Why do better questions lead to better learning?"

Node 4: Verify Before You Believe

THE BIG IDEA

- Verifying is not extra work. Verifying is learning.
- If you check whether something is true, compare it, question it, and make sure it makes sense, you are building real understanding.
- AI can sound smarter than it actually is, and produce answers that sound polished but are not truly correct.
- The permanent PlayIQ rule: Verify before you believe.

The PlayIQ Verification Ritual

- 1. Does this make sense? (Do I understand it, or does it just sound smart?)
- 2. Can I explain it myself? (If I cannot explain it, I probably do not own it yet.)
- 3. Can I cross-check it? (Can I compare it with class notes or a trusted source?)
- 4. Is anything missing or suspicious? (Does it feel too confident, vague, or incomplete?)

AI voice vs your voice

- AI often writes in a polished, robotic, generic style.
- If you use AI to understand something, then write it using your own brain, your answer sounds natural, human, and like you actually own the material.

ACTIVITY: SPOT THE PROBLEM

Instructions:

- Read each answer and decide: Looks good, Needs checking, or Wrong.
- Then provide a full sentence explaining why.

Scenarios:

- "Photosynthesis is how plants make food using sunlight."
- "The Civil War ended in 1992."
- "A metaphor compares two things without using 'like' or 'as.'"
- "Fractions are always smaller than whole numbers."
- "The Earth has one moon."

Reflection Prompts:

- Take one real school concept and run the verification ritual on it. Write 2-4 sentences showing how you checked it.

MINI CHECK

- Why is verifying part of learning?

- What are the 4 steps of the PlayIQ Verification Ritual?
- Why can copying AI language make your work weaker instead of stronger?
- What is the difference between using AI to learn faster and using AI to cheat yourself?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"What does 'verify before you believe' mean in school?"

MODULE 2: DIGITAL SMARTS & HUMAN RESPONSIBILITY

Node 1: The Power Tool Principle

THE BIG IDEA

- Technology is a multiplier.
- That means it makes things bigger. If you are focused, it can make you more effective. If you are distracted, it can make you more distracted. If you are curious, it can help you learn faster. If you are lazy, it can help you avoid effort and become weaker.
- AI is not automatically good or bad. It becomes powerful depending on how you use it.

Think of AI like a power tool

- A power tool can help you build something faster.
- But if you use it carelessly, it can damage the thing you are trying to build.
- In this case, the thing you are building is your mind.

The better question

- The question is not just: "Can AI help me?"
- The better question is: "What is AI helping me become?"

Why this matters

- AI and the internet give you access to more knowledge, more tools, and more leverage than almost any generation before you.
- But it also means you have more responsibility.
- If you use these tools carelessly, they can work against you. If you use them consciously, they can become a real superpower.

ACTIVITY: SUPERPOWER OR SUPERWEAPON?

Instructions:

- For each example below, decide whether AI is being used like a Superpower or a Superweapon Against You.
- Write your answer and then explain your thinking in one sentence.
- Format: "Superpower — because..." or "Superweapon Against You — because..."

Scenarios:

- "I use AI to explain difficult science ideas in simpler words."
- "I use AI to scroll through random image prompts for an hour instead of studying."
- "I use AI to quiz me before a test."
- "I use AI to write my full answer so I don't have to think."
- "I use AI to help me plan my homework."
- "I use AI to avoid effort every time school feels hard."

Reflection Prompts:

- One way technology can become a superpower for me is:
- One way technology could become a superweapon against me is:

MINI CHECK

- What does it mean that technology is a multiplier?
- Why is AI not automatically good or bad?
- What is one sign that a tool is helping you become weaker instead of stronger?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain the Power Tool Principle to a younger student. Why does it matter how you use AI, not just whether you use it?"

Node 2: Truth, Trust, and Misinformation

THE BIG IDEA

- Not everything that sounds smart is true.
- And not everything you see online deserves your trust.
- One of the most important skills in the modern world is learning how to tell the difference between what is true, what is misleading, what is incomplete, and what only sounds believable.
- Bad information spreads fast. And if you believe things too quickly, you stop thinking clearly.

Why this matters

- A lot of false information sounds polished.
- It may use big words, sound confident, look professional, or be repeated by a lot of people.
- But repetition is not proof. Confidence is not proof. A polished answer is not proof.
- Real thinkers do not just absorb information — they examine it.

The Truth Filter

- 1. Is this actually true? Or does it just sound smart?
- 2. Where is this coming from? Is it based on something real, or just generated language?
- 3. Can I compare it with another trusted source? Do my notes, textbook, or teacher materials agree?
- 4. Is anything missing? Could this be partly true, but incomplete?

ACTIVITY: SPOT THE PROBLEM

Instructions:

- For each statement below, choose: Reliable, Needs Checking, or Likely False.
- Write your answer and explain: "Reliable — because..." or "Needs Checking — because..."

Scenarios:

- "Plants use sunlight to help make food."
- "The moon gives off its own light."
- "A paragraph is usually built around one main idea."
- "All metals are magnetic."
- "The internet always gives the fastest way to the truth."

Reflection Prompts:

- Why do you think people believe false or weak information so easily sometimes? Write 2–4 sentences.

MINI CHECK

- Why is confidence not the same as truth?
- What are the 4 parts of the Truth Filter?
- Why is comparing information with another source important?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

“Teach someone the Truth Filter. Explain each of the 4 questions and why they matter.”

Node 3: Attention, Distraction, and Algorithm Traps

THE BIG IDEA

- Your attention is valuable.
- A lot of apps, platforms, and content are designed to keep you watching, clicking, scrolling, and reacting.
- That means if you do not protect your attention, someone else will use it for their own goals.
- This is one of the biggest digital skills you can learn: knowing the difference between using technology on purpose and getting used by it.

Rest vs Escape

- Rest: You intentionally relax, reset, and recharge.
- Escape: You avoid what matters by disappearing into distraction.
- The internet can do both. The question is not "Am I online?" — the better question is "Am I using this on purpose?"

The Attention Check

- Why did I open this?
- Is this helping me or pulling me away?
- Am I creating, learning, or just consuming?
- Will I feel stronger or weaker after this?
- If you ask these questions often, you become much harder to distract.

ACTIVITY: TRAP AUDIT

Instructions:

- Write down 3 attention traps that pull you off track.
- Use this format for each trap:
 - Trap [#]: [name] | Why it gets me: [reason] | One boundary I can use: [boundary]
- Example — Trap 1: Short videos | Why it gets me: They are easy to keep watching without thinking | One boundary I can use: Set a timer before opening the app

Scenarios:

- Trap 1: [describe an attention trap that distracts you]
- Trap 2: [describe a second attention trap]
- Trap 3: [describe a third attention trap]

MINI CHECK

- What is the difference between rest and escape?

- Why is your attention valuable?
- What is one attention boundary you want to start using?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain the difference between rest and escape, and describe one attention trap from your own life."

Node 4: Human Responsibility and the Highest Path

THE BIG IDEA

- You are responsible for what you do with power.
- That includes your time, your attention, your words, your tools, and your choices.
- AI and the internet can help you become stronger, smarter, and more capable.
- But they can also help you become more distracted, less disciplined, and more dependent.
- That is why we use the Highest Path Test.

The Highest Path Test

- 1. Does this make me stronger or weaker?
- 2. Does this build my future or steal from it?
- 3. Is this true, or do I just want it to be true?
- 4. Would I be proud if someone I respect saw this choice?
- 5. Am I using this to create... or to escape?

Why this matters

- A lot of bad choices feel easy in the moment.
- That's why people copy things they didn't learn, believe things they didn't check, waste time they meant to use well, and let technology train their habits instead of choosing them.
- The highest path is not always the easiest choice. But it is the one that makes you stronger over time.

ACTIVITY: HIGHEST PATH SCENARIOS

Instructions:

- For each situation below, decide which choice is the highest path.
- Write: Which option is the highest path and why.
- Example — Situation: You have an essay due tomorrow. A: Ask AI to write the whole thing. B: Ask AI to help you organize your ideas and then write it yourself. → B is the highest path because it helps me learn and still do the work myself.

Scenarios:

- You are confused about a history topic. A: Copy an AI answer and move on. B: Ask AI to explain it simply, then quiz you.
- You are tired and don't want to study. A: Scroll videos for an hour. B: Do one 10-minute mission first, then decide what to do next.
- You want to impress your teacher. A: Turn in polished AI writing you don't understand. B: Learn the idea well, then write it in your own words.

- You find a confident online claim. A: Believe it because it sounds smart. B: Check whether it is true first.

Reflection Prompts:

- Which of the 5 Highest Path Test questions would help you most right now? Explain why in 2–3 sentences.

MINI CHECK

- What is the Highest Path Test?
- Why is the highest path not always the easiest path?
- Which Highest Path question do you think would help you most right now, and why?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain the Highest Path Test. Choose 2 of the 5 questions and explain what they mean in your own words."

Node 5: Integrity and Identity

THE BIG IDEA

- Every time you use AI, you are building a habit.
- And habits shape identity.
- That means every time you choose effort over shortcut, learning over copying, truth over convenience, or growth over escape — you are becoming a stronger kind of person.
- But every time you choose shortcuts that replace your thinking, you are training the opposite identity.

Cheating is an identity problem

- Cheating is not just a rule problem. It is an identity problem.
- If AI does the work and you pretend it is yours: your confidence becomes fake, your skill stays weak, your future depends on hiding what you can't actually do.
- That is a dangerous way to live.
- Real confidence comes from earned skill.

The PlayIQ principle

- "AI can coach me, but I earn the skill."
- This is why PlayIQ is built around this idea.
- Using AI to understand is coaching. Using AI to replace your thinking is cheating yourself.

ACTIVITY: COACH OR CHEAT?

Instructions:

- For each example below, decide whether it is: Coach, Cheat, or Borderline / Needs Caution.
- Write your answer and explain: "Coach — because..." or "Cheat — because..."

Scenarios:

- "I ask AI to write my paragraph and I turn it in."
- "I ask AI to give me a hint and then I finish the problem."
- "I ask AI to make me practice questions."
- "I copy an AI answer because I don't want to think."
- "I ask AI to help me organize my notes before I study."

Reflection Prompts:

- I want to become the kind of student who...
- One shortcut I want to stop using is...
- One stronger habit I want to build is...

MINI CHECK

- Why is cheating an identity problem, not just a school problem?
- What does "AI can coach me, but I earn the skill" mean?
- What kind of student do you want to become?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain why cheating yourself is different from just breaking a rule. What does it do to your identity over time?"

Node 6: Social Impact: Privacy, Respect, and Digital Power

THE BIG IDEA

- What you do online affects other people.
- Technology is not just about what helps you. It is also about what kind of impact you create.
- That means part of being smart with technology is learning to use it with respect, caution, responsibility, and self-control.

Why this matters

- Today, it is easy to share something too quickly, pass along misinformation, use someone else's image or words badly, invade privacy, or hurt people without fully thinking about the consequences.
- Being digitally smart means slowing down enough to ask: "Is this helpful, true, respectful, and responsible?"

The Pause Before Share Rule

- 1. Is it true?
- 2. Is it respectful?
- 3. Do I have the right to use or share it?
- 4. Could this hurt someone if I'm wrong?

ACTIVITY: PAUSE BEFORE SHARE

Instructions:

- For each situation below, decide the smartest action.
- Write: Best action and Why.
- Example — Situation: You see a shocking fact in a comment section. Best action: Don't share it yet. Why: I should check if it's true first.

Scenarios:

- A friend sends you a fake-looking image and says, "Post this, it's hilarious."
- You find an AI-generated paragraph online and want to use it in your work.
- You read an exciting fact that matches what you already believe.
- You want to repost something but you are not sure it is true.

Reflection Prompts:

- Why does digital power come with responsibility? Write 2–3 sentences in your own words.

MINI CHECK

- Why does digital power come with responsibility?

- What is the Pause Before Share Rule?
- Why should privacy and respect matter online?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain the Pause Before Share Rule to someone who has never heard of it. Why does it matter?"

MODULE 3: PRE-LEARN SYSTEM

Node 1: Topic Mapping

THE BIG IDEA

- Do not ask AI to explain everything at once.
- That usually creates too much information.
- First, ask AI to make a simple map.
- A learning map shows the main parts of a topic so your brain knows where to start.

Prompt to Use

- "Act as my PlayIQ learning coach. Help me pre-learn [topic] for school. Break it into 5 simple parts. Keep it clear and not overwhelming. Do not do my homework for me. After the map, ask me one question to check what I already understand."

Activity: Pre-Learn Map

- Fill in: Topic / Part 1 / Part 2 / Part 3 / Part 4 / Part 5
- The part I understand most is:
- The part that looks most confusing is:
- One question I have is:

ACTIVITY: PRE-LEARN MAP

Instructions:

- Choose one real school topic you are about to study.
- Use AI with the prompt above to generate a 5-part map.
- Fill in the activity fields below based on what AI gives you.

Scenarios:

- Topic I am pre-learning:
- Part 1 of the map:
- Part 2 of the map:
- Part 3 of the map:
- Part 4 of the map:
- Part 5 of the map:

Reflection Prompts:

- The part I understand most is:
- The part that looks most confusing is:
- One question I have is:

MINI CHECK

- Why is a topic map better than asking AI to explain everything at once?
- Which part of your map seems easiest?
- Which part should you study first?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain why mapping a topic before diving in makes learning faster. Use an example from your own school subject."

Node 2: First Principles

THE BIG IDEA

- A first principle is the main truth underneath a topic.
- It answers: What is this really about?
- If you understand the core idea, details become easier.

Prompt to Use

- "Explain the core idea of [topic] in three levels: 1. simple version, 2. normal school version, 3. slightly deeper version. Then ask me which version helped me most."

The 10-Line Summary Template

- 1. This topic is about...
- 2. The main idea is...
- 3. One key word is...
- 4. Another key word is...
- 5. A simple example is...
- 6. This example matters because...
- 7. One common mistake is...
- 8. I should remember...
- 9. I still need to check...
- 10. My best question for class is...

ACTIVITY: CORE IDEA CARD

Instructions:

- Use the prompt above with AI to get three levels of explanation for your topic.
- Rate each level (1-5) and write your own one-sentence explanation.

Scenarios:

- Topic:
- Simple version (and my rating 1-5):
- Normal school version (and my rating 1-5):
- Deeper version (and my rating 1-5):
- The version that helped me most was:
- My own one-sentence explanation:

Reflection Prompts:

- Write your 10-Line Summary (all 10 lines in your own words):

MINI CHECK

- What is the core idea of your topic?
- Which explanation level helped you most?
- What question would you ask your teacher or AI next?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain the core idea of your chosen topic to someone who has never heard of it. Use the simplest level that is still accurate."

Node 3: Example-First Learning

THE BIG IDEA

- Examples help your brain see how the idea works.
- A strong pattern is: example first, pattern second, rule third, practice fourth.
- A non-example is also useful because it shows what the idea is not.

Prompt to Use

- "Give me 2 simple examples of [topic], 1 non-example, and explain why each one matters. Keep the examples school-appropriate and easy to understand. After that, ask me to explain the difference between the example and non-example."

Example from the PDF

- Topic: Metaphor
- Example 1: "The classroom was a zoo." — compares classroom to a zoo without using like or as.
- Example 2: "His voice was thunder." — directly compares voice to thunder.
- Non-example: "His voice was like thunder." — uses like, so it is a simile, not a metaphor.
- Pattern: A metaphor compares two things directly.

ACTIVITY: EXAMPLE STACK

Instructions:

- Use AI with the prompt above for your chosen topic.
- Record the 2 examples, 1 non-example, and the pattern you noticed.

Scenarios:

- Topic:
- Example 1 and why it fits:
- Example 2 and why it fits:
- Non-example and why it does NOT fit:
- The pattern I notice is:

Reflection Prompts:

- Which example helped most and why?
- What did the non-example make clearer?

MINI CHECK

- Which example helped most?
- What did the non-example make clearer?

- What pattern did you notice?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Teach someone what a non-example is and why using one helps you understand the real idea faster."

Node 4: Self-Test Loop

THE BIG IDEA

- You do not know something just because it sounds familiar.
- You know it when you can answer questions, fix mistakes, explain it in your own words, and use it without copying.
- That is why every pre-learn session ends with a self-test.

Prompt to Use

- "Quiz me on [topic] one question at a time. Start easy, then make it a little harder. Do not give me the answer until I try. If I get one wrong, explain the mistake simply and ask a follow-up question."

Learning Supercharger Note

- When your future AI tutor helps with this topic, it should remember:
 - - Explanation style that helped most
 - - The part that was most confusing
 - - The mistake you made
 - - Best practice style
 - - One thing to quiz you on next

ACTIVITY: 5 SELF-TEST QUESTIONS

Instructions:

- Use the prompt above with AI. Record all 5 questions AI asked you.
- Write your answer and whether you got it correct.
- Track your score and what you learned from any mistakes.

Scenarios:

- Question 1 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 2 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 3 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 4 + my answer + correct or not yet:
- Question 5 + my answer + correct or not yet:

Reflection Prompts:

- Score: __ / 5. One mistake I made was:
- The fix was:
- One thing I understand better now is:

MINI CHECK

- Why should AI wait until you try before giving answers?
- What did your self-test reveal?
- What should your future Learning Supercharger remember about how you learn?

TEACH BACK PROMPT

"Explain why a self-test is more powerful than rereading. What does testing prove that rereading does not?"